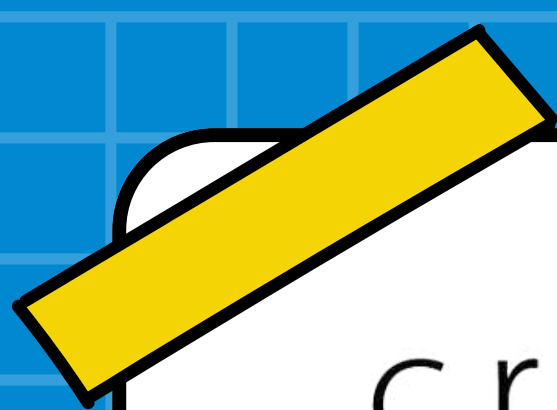


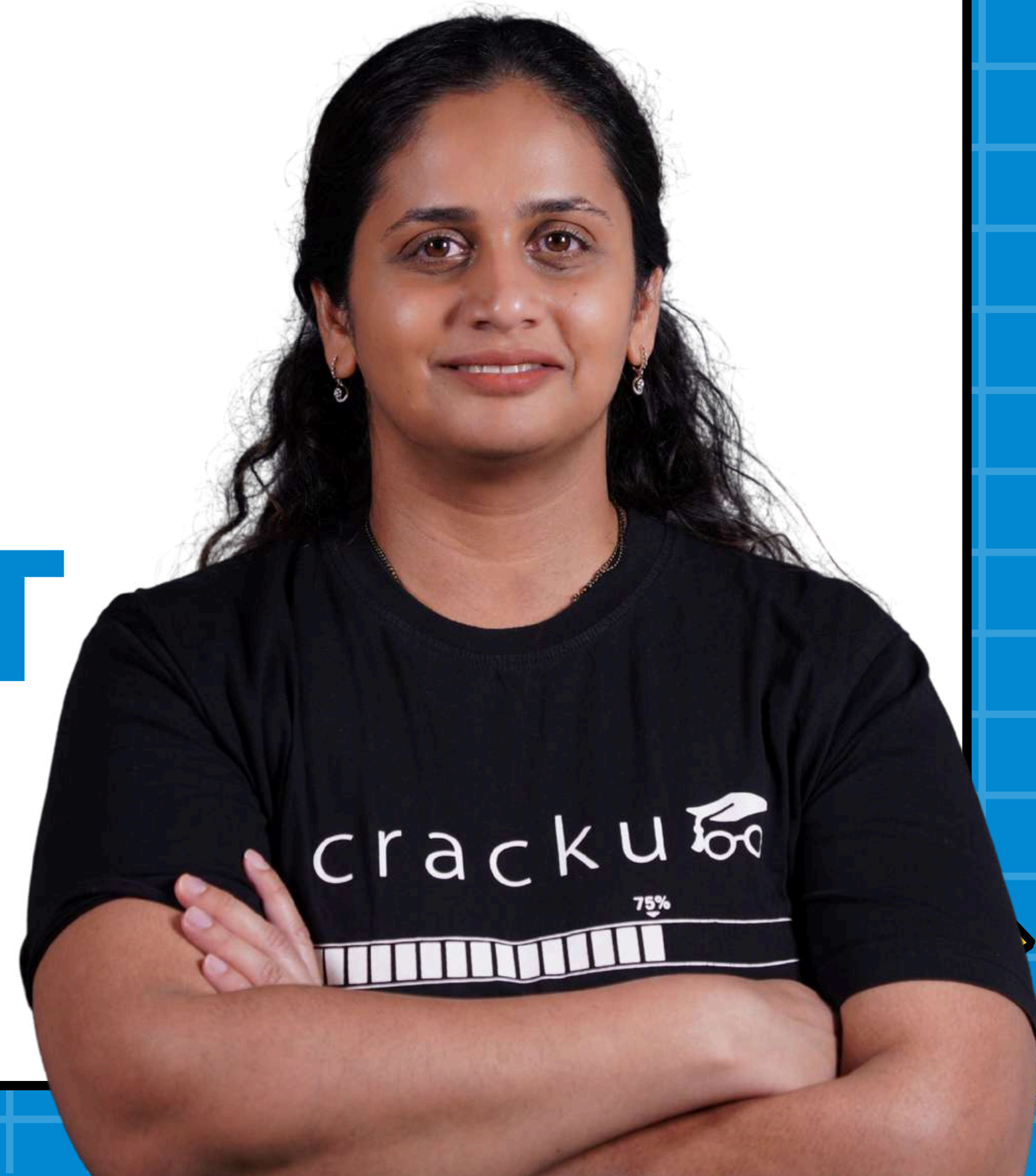


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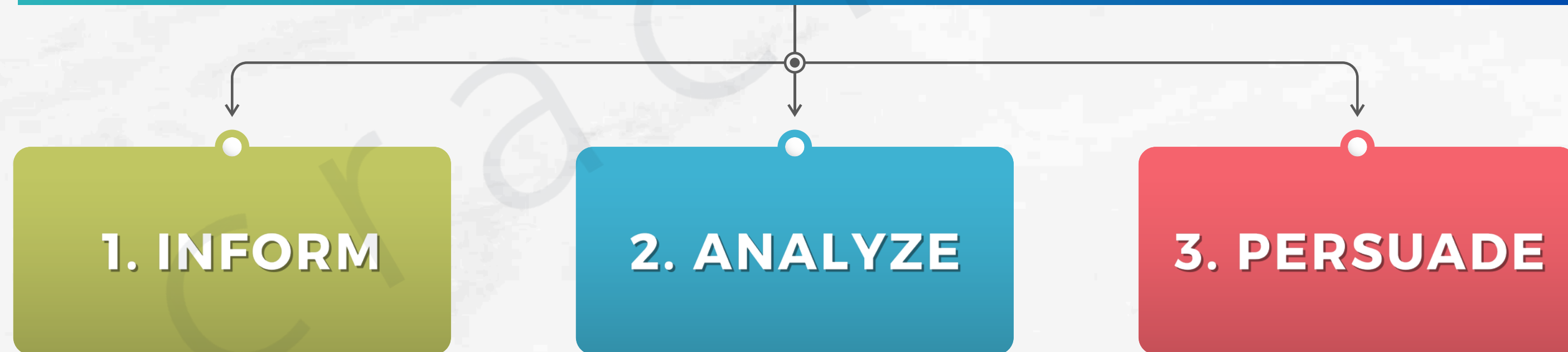
CHEAT SHEET

By CAT VARC 99.92%iler



Reading Comprehension

PURPOSE OF THE PASSAGE



1 Inform

Provides factual or explanatory content without strong opinions



Explain

Clarifies a concept, phenomenon, or process (ex, how climate change affects ocean currents)



Describe | Narrate

Paints a detailed picture of an event, person, or place (ex, an ancient civilisation's daily life)



Correct a Misconception

Addresses a widespread misunderstanding objectively and sets the record straight (ex, debunking myths about AI replacing human creativity)



Report

Presents findings or developments in a neutral manner (ex, summarising a scientific breakthrough)



Compare and Contrast

Discusses similarities or differences without necessarily taking a stance (ex, comparing capitalism and socialism)

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2

Analyze

Explores an idea, phenomenon, or event in depth, often without advocating a specific position



Introspect

Reflects on a concept, philosophy, or personal experience (ex, the nature of free will)



Evaluate an Event or Theory

Examines historical or contemporary events (ex: the impact of the Industrial Revolution on modern economies)



Explore Cause-Effect Relationships

Identifies reasons and consequences (ex: how colonialism shaped global trade)



Synthesise Information

Connects multiple ideas or perspectives to draw a broader conclusion (ex, linking neuroscience and philosophy to discuss consciousness)



Discuss a Debate

Presents both sides of an argument without taking a clear position (ex, the pros and cons of universal basic income)

3 Persuade

Tries to convince the reader of a viewpoint



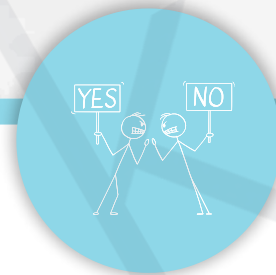
Criticise

Critically evaluates an idea, policy, or trend (ex: why social media is detrimental to democracy)



Call for Action

Urges the reader or society to act (ex: advocating for stricter environmental policies)



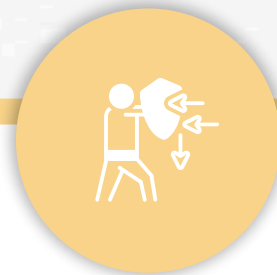
Argue For or Against

Takes a stance on an issue with logical reasoning (ex: arguing against capital punishment)



Advocate a Solution

Proposes a specific course of action (ex: how governments should regulate cryptocurrency)



Defend a Position

Justifies an existing belief or decision against criticism (ex: why central banks should intervene in recessions)

QUESTION TYPES



1. Big Picture Questions

[What is the passage about as a whole?]

Main Idea

Identifies the core concept the passage revolves around

Primary Purpose

Asks why the author wrote the passage (inform, analyse, persuade, etc.)

Tone

Highlight the emotional or rhetorical stance

2. Inference-based Questions

[What can be logically concluded from the passage?]

Implicit Inference

Requires connecting ideas across the passage

Assumption

Identify the underlying belief that the argument depends on

Agree or Disagree

Find statements that align with the author's stance

Implication-Based

What might happen or follow if the author's reasoning is accepted

3. Fact-Based Questions

[What does the passage explicitly state?]

EXPLICIT DETAIL

Tests direct retrieval of information

CONSISTENT STATEMENT

Asks whether given statements are directly supported or contradicted

4. Structure-Based Questions

[How is the passage constructed?]

FUNCTION

Asks why a paragraph, example or sentence exists (introduce, counter, conclude, etc.)

LOGICAL PROGRESSION

Examines how one idea leads to another

5. Application-Based Questions

[How does the passage relate to a new context?]

REAL-WORLD APPLICATION

Asks how the idea might work in a different setting

ANALOGY OR HYPOTHETICAL SCENARIO

Requires selecting new situations that parallel the ones in the passage

6. Evaluative Questions

[What attacks or supports the author's view?]

WEAKEN

Identifies what undermines the passage's logic

STRENGTHEN

Finds extra support for the author's stance

OPTION ELIMINATION

List of Distortions

1

**Subtle
Distortions**

2

**Explicit
Distortions**

3

**Logical
Distortions**

4

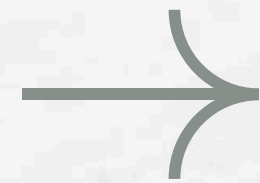
**Structural
Distortions**

1 Subtle Distortions



Word Choice

option contains subtle changes in wording, which alters the meaning of a statement or passage, leading to misinterpretation.



Ambiguity

option introduces ambiguous language or phrasing that can be interpreted in multiple ways.



Tone Shift

option slightly shifts the tone, changing the implied meaning; it might - at times - contain emotionally charged or biased language to sway the reader's interpretation.

Misrepresentation

option provides incorrect information or distorts facts directly in the passage.

1. Percentage vs. Quantity: option misrepresents a percentage as a quantity (when the sample size is undefined)
2. Probable vs. Certain: option distorts the degree of certainty, presenting probable events or outcomes and definite/certain ones

Non-Sequitur (Irrelevant conclusion)

option draws a conclusion that does not logically follow from the premises provided in the passage.

Red Herring

option presents irrelevant information to distract from the main point or argument of the passage.

A

B

C

D

E

Exaggeration

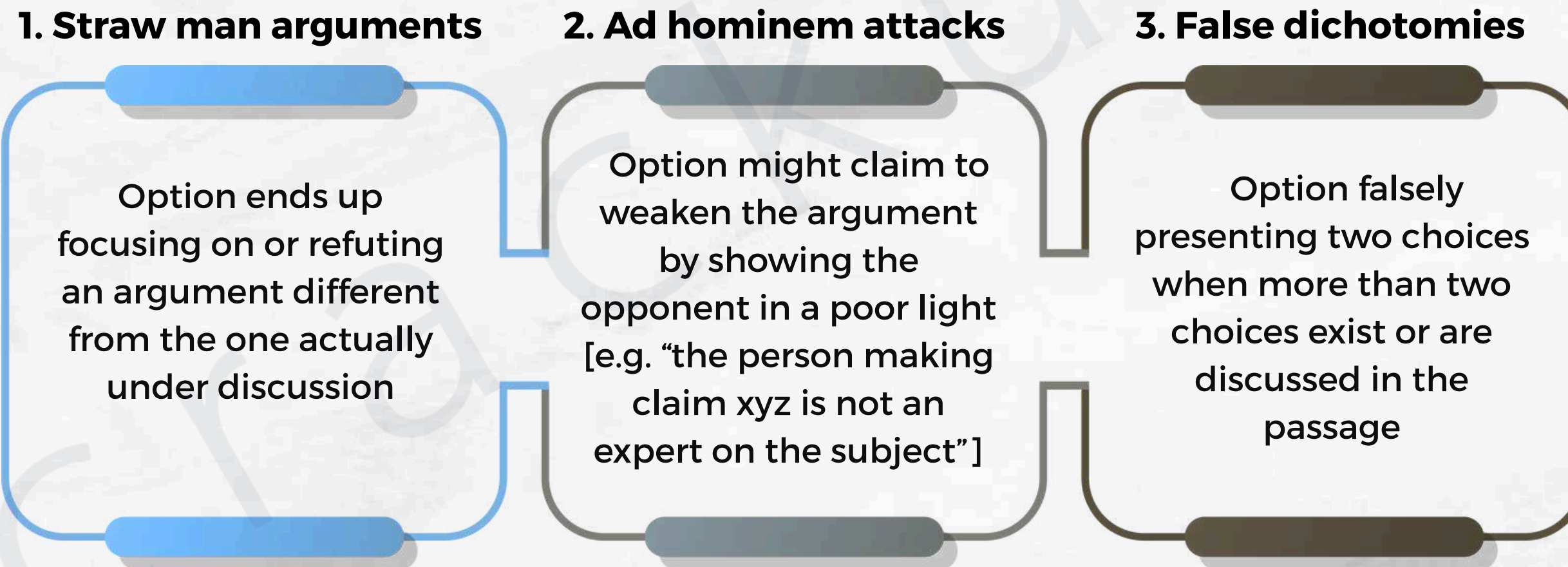
option magnifies certain aspects of the passage to mislead the reader; it might contain extreme language (e.g., "always," "never") that exaggerates or misrepresents the author's viewpoint.

False Causation/relation

option incorrectly shows that one event caused another event simply because they occurred in sequence/simultaneously or are related

Fallacies:

option introduces logical fallacies such as straw man arguments, ad hominem attacks, or false dichotomies [in the case of weaken/undermine questions]



Assumption Errors:

option relies on assumptions not supported by the passage

4

Structural Distortions

1. **Shift in Focus:** option focuses on points that might be correct based on the passage but are not relevant to the question.
2. **Scope Distortion:** option expands or narrows the scope of the passage or specific idea discussed;

SCOPE DISTORTION

- **Oversimplification:** option simplifies a nuanced or complex point, thereby leading to misinterpretation.
- **Generalisation:** option uses an example or idea to create a generalisation or blanket comment that is not supported by the passage

APPROACH TO READING

1

**Follow
Active
Reading**

2

**Read from
Different
Sources**

3

**Reading
Source
List**



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1. FOLLOW ACTIVE READING

- Engaging with the text by questioning, anticipating, and identifying logical patterns instead of passively scanning words

What is it?

Why is it important?

How to Apply Active Reading?

- Helps quickly identify main ideas, purpose, and tone
- Reduces the need for re-reading by improving retention and comprehension
- Enhances speed and accuracy in answering questions

Ask questions before and during reading:

1. What is the passage trying to convey?
2. What is the author's stance - neutral, critical, persuasive?
3. What kind of argument or evidence is being used?

Spot structural markers:

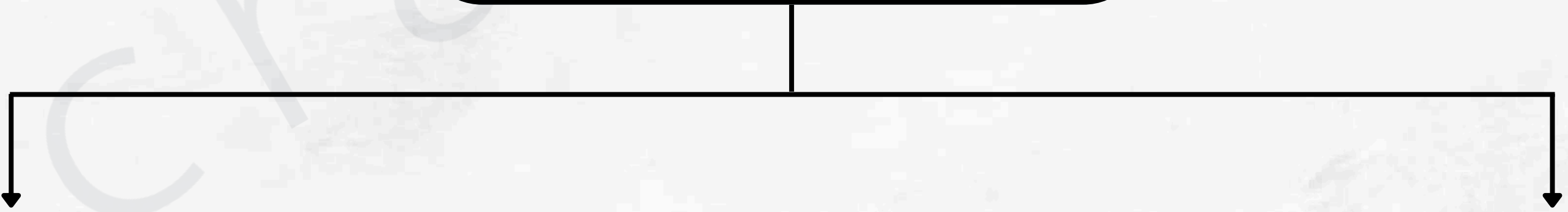
1. Contrast: However, On the other hand, In contrast → signals a shift in argument
2. Cause & Effect: Therefore, Thus, As a result, Consequently → indicates relation and conclusions
3. Emphasis: Indeed, Notably, Significantly → often highlights key points

2. READ FROM DIFFERENT SOURCES

- **Why is it important?**

CAT passages come from a variety of disciplines - Philosophy, Science, Business, Sociology, Politics, Literature, and so on. Regular exposure to different writing styles makes comprehension faster and more intuitive.

How should you approach it?



```
graph TD; A[How should you approach it?] --> B[Set Up a Reading Log]; A --> C[Step-by-Step Reading Routine];
```

Set Up a Reading Log

Step-by-Step Reading Routine

Set Up a Reading Log



Create a 'Google Doc' and add a 'Tab' for one article each day



Label Tab entries by Date & Genre (e.g. April 11_Philosophy)

Handling New Words:



Try to guess the meaning using contextual clues before looking it up.



Ask yourself:

- *Could I have ignored this word and still understood the passage?*
- *Did the word affect my grasp of the main idea?*



Write the meaning or description (for concepts) as used in the passage and review it after 7 days.

Step-by-Step Reading Routine

ROUND 1 - Initial Reading (7-10 min)

1. Read without pausing: focus on understanding the passage's flow
2. Identify the structure: does the passage explain, analyze, or persuade?
3. Look for the author's stance: is the tone neutral, positive, or critical?

ROUND 2 - Detailed Reading (10-12 min)

1. Create thought units: write a one-line summary for each paragraph in the doc
2. Identify the Pivot Points: where does the argument shift?

FINAL QUICK ANALYSIS (5 min)

At the end of the passage, answer these questions:

- What is the author's tone?
- What is the purpose of the article?
- What is the overarching message?
- What new words and concepts did I learn?

3. Reading Source List

SCIENCES	CULTURE POLITICS	PHILOSOPHY	HISTORY ARTS LITERATURE	BUSINESS ECONOMICS	OTHER SOURCES
Big Think	First Things	Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy	Public Books	IMF Blogs	Aeon
Psyche	Discourse Mag	Argumenta	The Marginalian	Fast Company	Noema Mag
Nautilus Mag	Social Europe	Metapsychology Online Review	Art Forum	The Economic Journal	JSTOR Daily
WIRED	The Guardian		All Thats Interesting	VoxEU	The Hedgehog Review
	Quillette		History Today	Engage EPW	Inquiries Journal
	The Washington Post		History Is Now Mag	Econofact	The Public Domain Review
	Reuters				The Conversation

CRITICAL REASONING INPUTS

For improving at RCs

1

**Argument/
Paragraph
Components**

2

Framework

3

**Logical
Fallacies to
Watch Out
For**

1

Argument/Paragraph Components

**A****Premise:**

A set of facts or statements that provides the foundation of the argument

B**Conclusion:**

The main claim or recommendation derived from the premise

C**Assumption:**

An unstated link between the premise and conclusion that must be true for the argument to hold

D**Inference:**

A logical deduction based on the given information, without introducing new assumptions

2 Framework

Identify purpose of the question: Strengthen claim? Weaken argument? Identify assumption?
Figure out valid inferences? Explain structure?



A. How can we strengthen an argument?

Fill gaps in reasoning

Offer evidence to support the premise

Confirm the validity of underlying assumptions

B. How can we weaken an argument?

Negate necessary assumptions

Offer evidence contradicting the premise

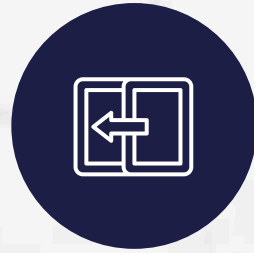
Highlight logical flaws or alternative explanations

C. What can be a valid inference?

Presents an unstated idea

Does not misrepresent or distort the information

D. How do we understand the structure?



Ask 'Why':

"Why did the author include this part?" Consider if it's:

- introducing a new idea
- supporting a claim
- contrasting something

Transitions:

Pay attention to transitions (e.g., words like "however," "for example", "in contrast"). These indicate shifts in arguments or ideas that can reveal how the passage is organized.

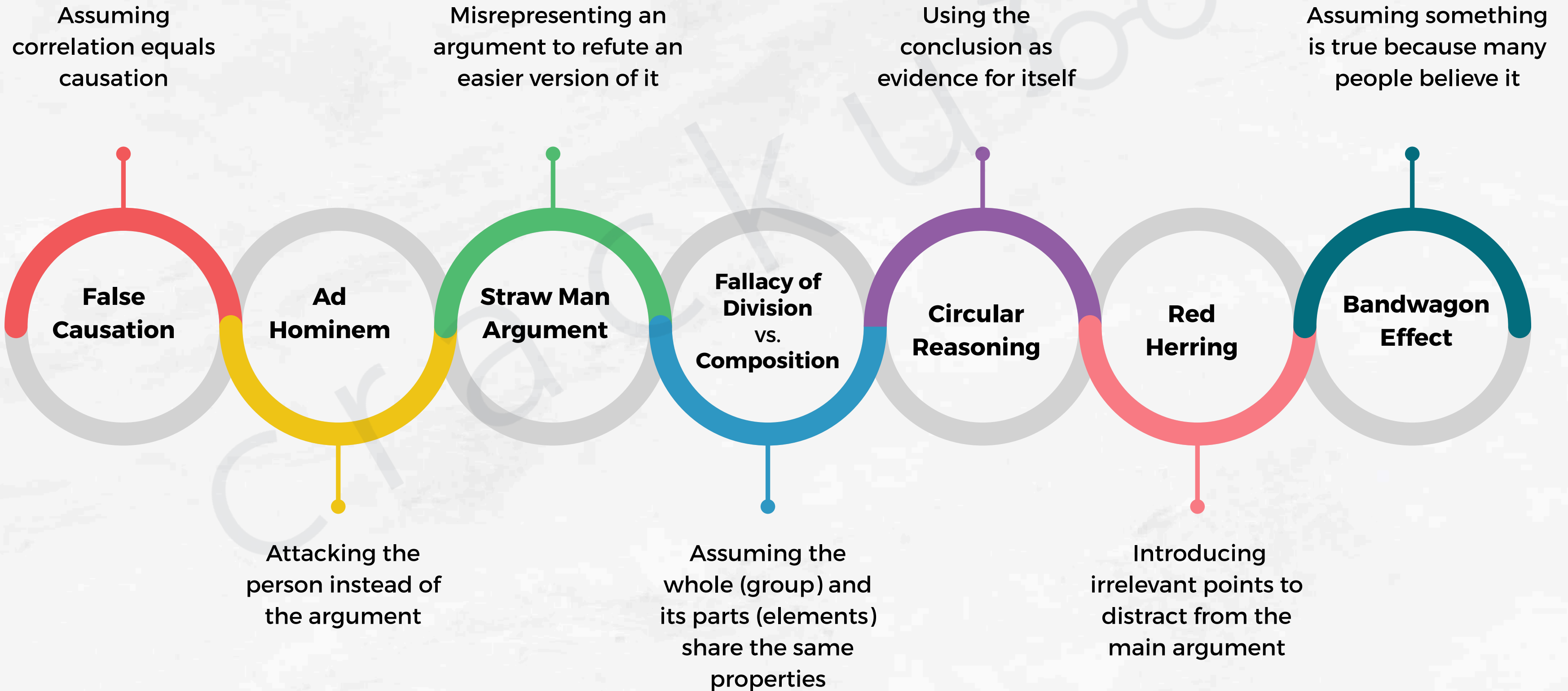
Examples:

Be on the lookout for examples that support or undermine the main idea. Mark them mentally or take brief notes.

Themes:

Note down the core themes and the author's attitude towards the subject.

3 Logical Fallacies to Watch Out For



Paragraph Summary Questions



1. Essentials of an ideal summary

- Core idea
- Author's Intent

2. Option elimination approach

- Irrelevant details
- Distortion
- Examples | Analogics | Metaphors
- Tone | Scope Inconsistency

1. Essentials of an Ideal Summary

CORE IDEA

- summary must capture the central theme of the paragraph without unnecessary details

- if the paragraph is analytical, explanatory, or argumentative, the summary should retain the same tone and intent

AUTHOR'S INTENT

2. Option Elimination Approach

IRRELEVANT DETAILS

- Shift in Focus: An option may distract you by shifting the focus away from the main argument to a minor or unrelated point

- Tone Shift: At times, options might reflect a tone that is not consistent with the paragraph

- Scope Distortion: [Broad vs. Narrow]
The correct answer should accurately reflect the passage's scope

TONE | SCOPE INCONSISTENCY



A few types of distortions that commonly appear in exams:

- **Misrepresentation:** [New idea or Incorrect interpretation]
Watch out for options that twist the author's statements
- **Exaggeration:** Some options might amplify the author's point to an extreme
- **False Causation/Relation:** Be cautious of options that incorrectly establish a cause-and-effect relationship



Include? Yes/No

- Yes, if the option captures the central idea along with the example/analogy/metaphor or if the example/analogy is central to the argument
- No, if the option focuses purely on the example/analogy/metaphor without presenting the main idea

Parajumble | Paragraph Completion Questions

Cause-effect indicators

1

Comparative indicators

2

Supplementary idea markers

3

Grammar-based logic

4

1. Cause-Effect Indicators

These characterise the causality present in the paragraph.

- Direct causation: Because, Since, As, Due to, Owing to, For this reason

- Result indicators: Therefore, Thus, Hence, Consequently, As a result, Accordingly, So, Which led to

- Conditional Cause-Effect: If...then, Provided that, Given that, In case, Unless

- Negative Cause-Effect: Otherwise, If not, Were it not for



2. Comparative Indicators

These portray a comparison between two independent statements.

Similarity & Agreement:

Similarly, Likewise,
In the same way,
Correspondingly,
Analogously, Just
as

Contrast & Opposition:

However, Yet, But, On
the other hand, In
contrast, Contrarily,
Although, Though,
Even though, Despite,
Nevertheless,
Nonetheless, Whereas,
Conversely

Degree of Difference:

More importantly,
To a lesser extent,
To a greater extent,
While, Rather than

3. Supplementary Idea Markers

These present supplementary ideas or detail to another point (main point)



Adding information:

Additionally, Furthermore,
Moreover, Also, Besides, What's
more, Not to mention



Clarification & Emphasis:

That is, In other words, Namely,
To put it differently, To clarify



Expanding on an idea:

In addition to, Along with,
Coupled with, Together with,
Apart from that



Sequencing a list:

First, Second, Third, Next, Then,
Subsequently

4. Grammar-based logic

A

Noun-Pronoun Relationship

Sentences that begin with a pronoun usually follow a sentence with the noun that the pronoun replaces.

B

Name-Surname Relationship

Most of the time, the introductory sentence might address the person by their full name, and all subsequent statements will likely replace this name with pronouns or surnames.

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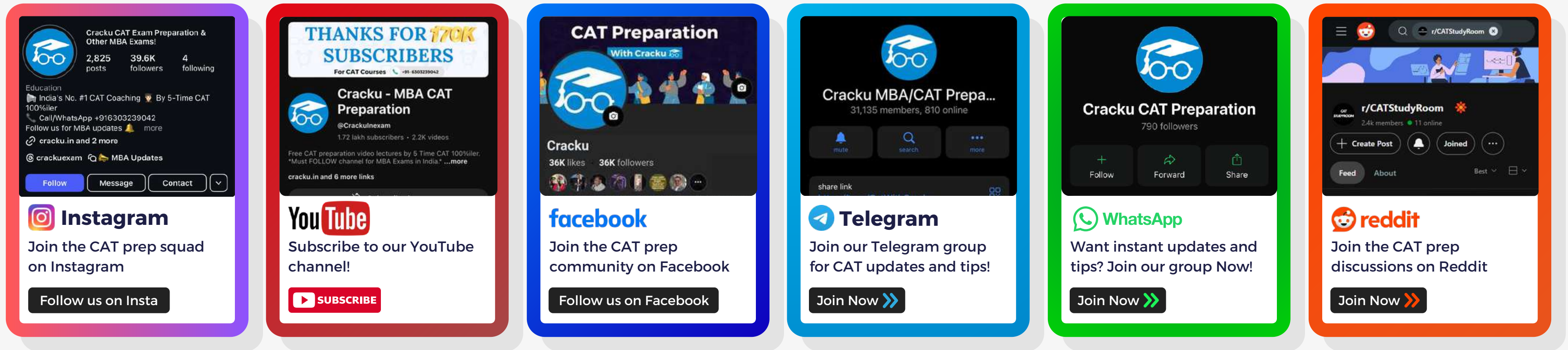
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